13.	Atal Bihari Vajpayee	1968 – 1972	Madhya Pradesh (Gwalior); RSS
14.	L.K. Advani	1973 – 1977	Sindhi from Karachi, RSS

The short tenures of the early Jan Sangh leaders pointed to conflict at the top of the party structure between Mookerjee loyalists and those from the RSS. As B.D. Graham has argued, 'The essential clash in 1954 was between the young RSS organisers, intent upon making the Jana Sangh more centralized and disciplined, and Sharma's relatively weak group of secondary leaders, trying ineffectually to defend what remained of Mookerjee's project for an open and democratic party.'[97] The clash was typified in a formal statement issued by Mookerjee's successor, Mauli Chandra Sharma, on 4 November 1954:[98]

Acute differences of opinion on the question of interference by the RSS in its affairs of the Jana Sangh have been growing for over a year. Many RSS workers have entered into the party since its inception. They were welcomed, as RSS leaders had publicly declared that it was a purely cultural body having nothing to do with politics and that its members were perfectly free to join any political party. In practice, however, it did not prove to be so.

The late Dr Mookerjee was often seriously perturbed by the demands of RSS leaders for a decisive role in matters like the appointment of office-bearers, nomination of candidates for elections and matters of policy. We however hoped that the rank and file of the RSS would be drawn into the arena of democratic public life through their association with the Jana Sangh.

A vigorous and calculated drive was launched to turn the Jana Sangh into a convenient handle of the RSS. Orders were issued from their headquarters through their emissaries and the Jana Sangh was expected to carry them out. Many workers and groups all over the country resented this and the Delhi State Jana Sangh as a body refused to comply.